

NEW BIRTH: WHEN CHRIST'S LIFE BECOMES YOURS

The Sinner Believes; the Spirit Gives Life

When the sinner entrusts himself to Christ, the Holy Spirit joins him to the risen Son and gives new life. Christ's life becomes the believer's life.



BIG IDEA

The Spirit gives new life by joining the believing sinner to the risen Christ.

KEY SCRIPTURE

John 3:1-8

ALSO READ

Romans 6:1-11

MEMORY VERSE

1 JOHN 5:12

"He that hath the Son hath life; and he that hath not the Son of God hath not life."

MAIN QUESTION

What Happens When a Sinner Entrusts Himself to Christ?

45 MINUTES

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SESSION SNAPSHOT



SESSION GOALS

- Hold the sinner's faith and the Spirit's life-giving together.
- Understand regeneration as life received in union with Christ.
- See several doctrines as dimensions of one saving event.
- Recognize eternal life as present now and bodily complete later.

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OPENING ACTIVITY: "ONE NEW LIFE - MANY REALITIES"

1

ASK WHAT BIRTH ESTABLISHES (2 MIN)

Write LIFE, ORIGIN, FAMILY, IDENTITY, INHERITANCE, and FUTURE. Ask whether these arrive as six unrelated transactions or belong together because one new life exists.

2

KEEP THE BIBLICAL IMAGE CENTRAL (2 MIN)

Jesus says a person must be born of the Spirit. Birth language tells us that God gives life and that a genuinely new existence begins.

3

NAME THE MEETING (2 MIN)

Review Sessions 9-10: the sinner turns and trusts. At conversion, the Spirit does what the sinner cannot do: He joins the believer to Christ and gives life.

4

READ THE SOURCE OF LIFE (2 MIN)

Read 1 John 5:11-12. Eternal life is not a detached substance placed inside someone. The life is in the Son; the person who has the Son has life.

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LEADER GUARDRAIL

Do not place regeneration before saving faith or describe preparatory grace as life already ignited. Faith does not generate life, and the Spirit does not believe. Do not imply that union absorbs the person into God or gives divine aseity. Believers share Christ's risen human life while remaining creatures.

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PREPARE

- Bible
- Board or paper
- Six birth-reality words
- Student handouts
- Review Sessions 8-10

The sinner believes; the Spirit gives life. In conversion, these distinct actions meet.

The Sinner Believes; the Spirit Gives Life

When the sinner entrusts himself to Christ, the Holy Spirit joins him to the risen Son and gives new life. Christ's life becomes the believer's life.



B CORE TEACHING

1 THE SINNER BELIEVES; THE SPIRIT GIVES LIFE John 1:12-13

The sinner genuinely receives Christ in trusting surrender. The Spirit genuinely gives what faith cannot produce: new life. Neither performs the other's action; in conversion they meet.

EMPHASIZE: Faith does not regenerate, and the Spirit does not believe.

2 THE SPIRIT JOINS THE BELIEVER TO CHRIST Rom. 6:4-11

Regeneration is not a detachable substance implanted apart from Jesus. The Spirit joins the believer to the risen Son so that Christ's life becomes his life.

EMPHASIZE: Union names the relationship; regeneration names the life-giving act.

3 A NEW ORIGIN AND EXISTENCE BEGIN 2 Cor. 5:17

New birth names the believer's new origin, identity, family, inheritance, and future. New creation names the resulting existence in Christ, not merely improvement of Adam's old life.

EMPHASIZE: The same person remains, but now belongs to Christ's new humanity.

4 ETERNAL LIFE BEGINS NOW 1 John 5:11-12

The believer possesses the risen Son's life now through the Spirit. His mortal body may still die, but death cannot sever him from Christ. Bodily resurrection will complete what has begun.

EMPHASIZE: Received life is deathless yet always dependent upon God.

1 ONE EVENT - MANY DIMENSIONS

CONVERSION

decisive passage

REGENERATION

Spirit gives life

UNION

relationship established

NEW BIRTH

new origin

ETERNAL LIFE

life now and forever

NEW CREATION

new existence

? DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1 What does the sinner do, and what does the Spirit do?

Follow-up: Why must neither action be assigned to the other?

2 Why is regeneration inseparable from union with Christ?

Follow-up: Where does the new life remain?

3 How do new birth and new creation differ in emphasis?

Follow-up: New origin or new existence?

4 Why is eternal life more than endless existence?

Follow-up: Whose risen life does the believer share?

5 What has begun now, and what still awaits resurrection?

Follow-up: Can bodily death separate a believer from Christ?

! WEEKLY REFLECTION

Read Romans 6:1-11 and 1 John 5:11-12. Mark every phrase connecting life to Christ.

- Am I looking for benefits apart from the Son?
- What new identity belongs to someone in Christ?

+ PRIVATE CONVERSATION

Do not pronounce new birth merely because a student repeated words. Ask whom he is trusting and whether he has surrendered himself to Christ; point him to the Son in whom life is found.

N LEADER NOTES

- No regeneration before faith.
- Life is in Christ, not detached.
- One event, many dimensions.
- No divine aseity for creatures.
- Present life; future body.

He that hath the Son hath life: Christ Himself remains the believer's life.